



Goal check-ins and individual goals at DeepL

Introduction

Setting clear, actionable goals is a key part of driving success at DeepL. Whether it's aligning with company objectives, contributing to team achievements, or focusing on personal growth, goals give direction to your efforts and help measure progress.

This guide will provide you with everything you need to set, track, and achieve meaningful goals that make an impact.

This topic applies to...

All employees.

Contacts

For any queries → reach out to **your Lead**

Table of contents

- Key dates for 2025
- Background
- Why are goals important?
- How Goals Work at DeepL?
- Learn the basics of goal setting
- Quarterly goal check-ins
- FAQs

Resources

- [Values](#)
- [bob Demo on Goals](#)
- [Personal Development Plans](#)
- [DeepL Academy Course for Employees](#) NEW
- [DeepL Academy Course for Leads](#) NEW



Key dates for 2025

Goal setting will start in January 2025.

The dates below are significant for your action:

- **6-31 January**: Set your Goals for 2025 with your Lead. Make sure your goals are in Bob by **31 January**.
- **1st - 30th April**: Have your First quarterly Check-in with your lead (in bob)
- **1-31 July**: Have your second quarterly Check-in with your lead (in Bob)
- **1-31 October**: Have your third quarterly Check-in with your lead (in Bob)

This is the holistic timeline for the whole year for Goals:



Background

As part of DeepL's strategic priorities for 2025, we are strengthening our commitment to a results-oriented mindset. Goals are essential for setting clear expectations, fostering valuable feedback, and ensuring accountability across all teams. In 2024, we introduced the foundation for individual goal-setting across the company.

From 2025, we are evolving this approach by incorporating goals as a **required practice** for all employees, along with regular check-ins to track progress and maintain alignment with our company objectives. This ensures that everyone's efforts contribute to DeepL's collective success.

Why are goals important?

- ➔ To keep all of us **aligned** and heading in the same strategic direction.

We are growing fast, and in a 1000+ organisation we want to make sure what we are working on as individuals is aligned to DeepL's priorities.

- ➔ To give **clarity** of what's expected of you.

By setting and agreeing goals with your lead, you know what needs to be done and by when.

- ➔ To help you **prioritise and focus**, making sure you stay on track

'We build for scale, quality and think long-term'.

Established goals help us think ahead. During moments of intense work and requests piling up - they remind us of our priorities and where our focus should be.

- ➔ To build **accountability**, by making progress and impact visible

'We are decisive, move fast and act as owners'.

Individual goals bring clarity on where you make an impact, whether that's how you will contribute to your team's success or to your own personal growth and development. As a lead, it gives you objective visibility to support accomplishment and development conversations.

- ➔ To help you **enlist support early** when things go off track

'We care'.

Establishing goals means you can easily see when things aren't going to plan, and act early to get support from others and course correct. We are in this together because we care about the success of our team and the company.

- ➔ To provide opportunities to **reflect & iterate**, cultivating a growth mindset

'We are humble, open and value collaboration'.

Goal check-ins keep us agile, and create a moment to reflect on how we did in the past - and whether there's something we could do differently or improve in the future. They provide an opportunity for open feedback, and help us focus on delivering great solutions.

- ➔ Goals are a building block to scaling your **employee experience** at DeepL

Goals are fundamental to your performance and growth at DeepL, and conducting quarterly goal check-ins effectively simplifies performance reflections, making them more impactful and seamless.

⚙️ How Goals Work at DeepL?

The Cascade

At DeepL, goals align individual contributions with our broader strategy, ensuring clarity and focus across all levels. This cascading approach eliminates silos, clarifies priorities, and keeps everyone working toward shared success.

Here's how the cascade works:



- Company-wide goals set the strategic direction with high level objectives.
- Departments and/or Teams take these overarching goals and translate them into actionable priorities relevant to their specific focus
- For individual goals, department goals are further broken down into specific or personal objectives.

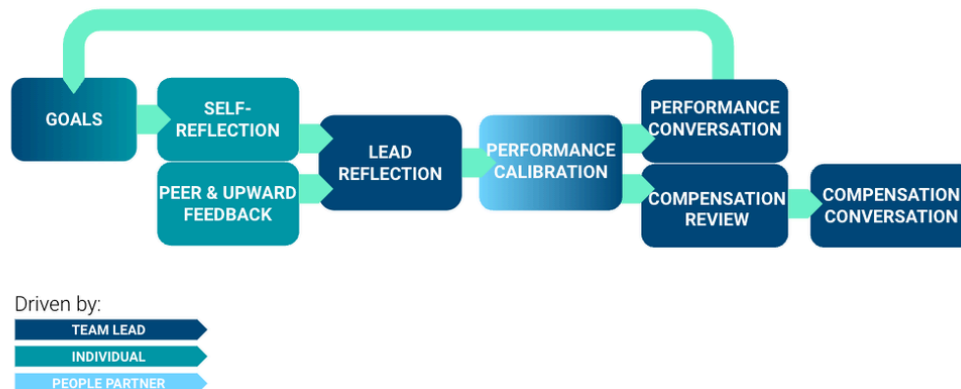
Goals and Performance Reviews

For Performance Reflections in 2025:

- From your performance conversation, you should align on development areas with your lead and following this, you may add or realign your goals for 2025 during your April Quarterly Check-In.

After 2025 Performance Reflection:

- Your goal progress should be considered as part of your self-reflections for the “what” section, which highlight your progress and specific impact at DeepL. In this image, you can see how goals are a crucial element in your performance reflections thus the need to have it as a required practice for 2025.
- Additionally, your ongoing quarterly check-in will continue to be used as feedback points and later can be a helpful source of information when writing your next Performance Reflections.



Goal Systems

We use both Elate and bob to ensure our goal-setting process is streamlined, transparent, and impactful.



Elate

Elate supports goal setting at the **company and department or team** levels, making it easier for leaders to align priorities and measure outcomes.

At-a-glance view of what's most important to the company, how we are performing, and how each department contributes

More details [here](#).



Bob (HiBob):

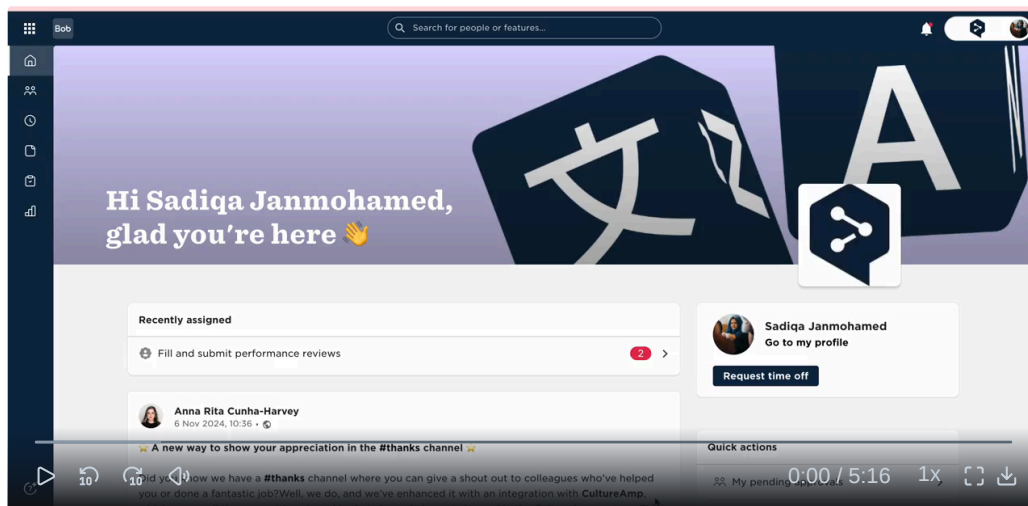
Bob is our go-to platform for setting and managing **individual** goals.

It provides an easy-to-navigate interface for creating, updating, and tracking progress on your goals.

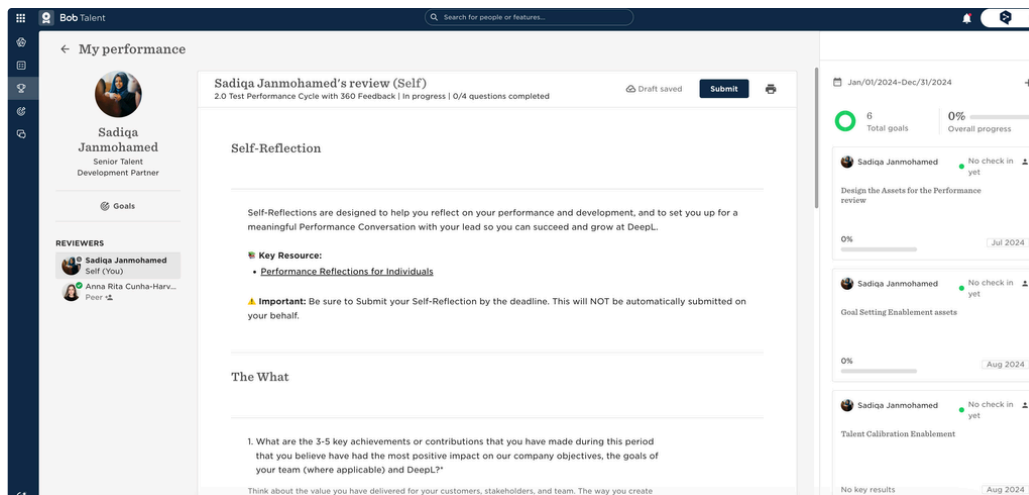
More details [here](#).

How do I use bob for goals?

For Employees:

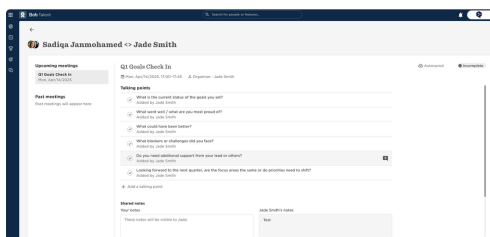


Goals in Performance Reflections

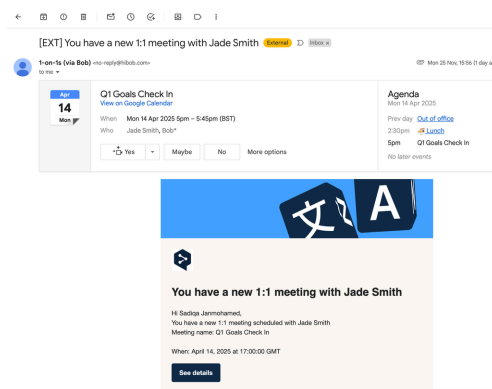


Check-in in bob

Check In in bob:



Event Invite:



- For Leaders:** This is how you can track and review goals as well as how to set quarterly check-in's on bob. Remember for the document to be shared to your direct report, you will need to be the initiator of the quarterly check in on bob.



Learn the basics of goal setting

We recommend setting 3-5 individual goals, that are aligned to the goals of your department and the company. In the spirit of growth mindset, we encourage you to have one focused on personal development.

Types of Individual Level Goals

Goals can fall into two main categories:

1. Goals related to team and company goals

These goals ensure that each employee's efforts directly support the broader objectives of their team, department, or the company as a whole. They help maintain alignment and foster a collaborative environment where every team member's contributions are crucial to collective success. Examples include:

- **Project-Specific Goals:** Completing specific tasks or milestones within a project timeline that contribute to the overall success of the project. For instance, developing a new feature for a software product by the end of the quarter.
- **Performance Metrics:** Achieving defined performance indicators such as sales targets, customer satisfaction scores, or production quotas. For example, increasing sales by 10% over the quarter to support the department's revenue goals.
- **Process Improvement Goals:** Identifying and implementing improvements in processes that enhance team efficiency or productivity. This could involve streamlining workflows or adopting new tools that facilitate better collaboration.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Engaging with other teams or departments to achieve shared goals, such as working with the marketing team to launch a new product or service.

2. Goals related to professional and personal development for individuals

These goals focus on your growth and well-being, ensuring you continue to develop skills, advance in your careers, and maintain a healthy work-life balance. Examples include:

- **Skill Development Goals:** Acquiring new skills or enhancing existing ones that are relevant to your role or future career aspirations. For instance, completing a certification course in project management or learning a new programming language.
- **Career Advancement Goals:** Setting milestones that lead to promotions, new responsibilities, or career progression. This might involve taking on leadership roles within projects or demonstrating capabilities in new areas.
- **Personal Development Goals:** Focusing on personal growth aspects such as improving work-life balance, enhancing time management skills, or adopting healthier lifestyle habits. Examples include establishing a regular exercise routine or setting boundaries to prevent burnout.
- **Learning and Education Goals:** Enrolling in formal education programs, attending industry conferences, or participating in professional development workshops. For example, attending a conference related to the latest industry trends and innovations.

Check out our FAQ on how many goals should be set per type of goal :)

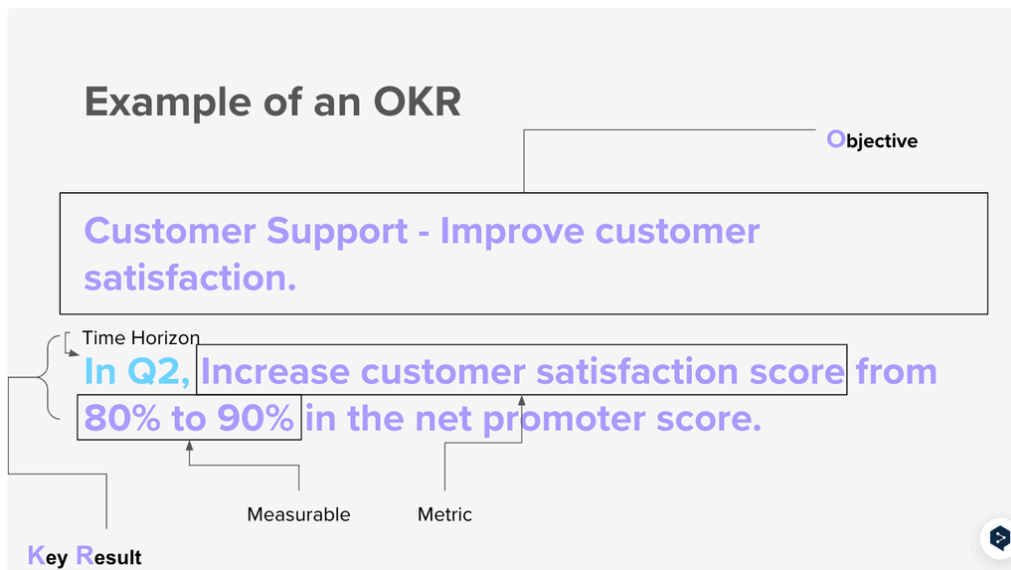
Goal Structure

We approach goal-setting to maximise impact using the OKR format. DeepL goals follow a straightforward format to ensure clarity and focus:

- **Action (Objective):** The "what" you aim to achieve—a specific, actionable outcome.
- **Measurement (Key Results):** The "criteria" for success—quantifiable indicators that track progress.

Why do we use OKR format?

- **Focus on Results:** Emphasise measurable outcomes through Key Results, so progress is always clear and actionable.
- **Encourage Ambition:** Set challenging but achievable Objectives that inspire innovation and growth.
- **Promote Accountability:** Regularly review progress and adjust as needed, keeping goals relevant and attainable.



An example of an OKR

To help clarify, here's some questions you can ask yourself when setting key results with an objective:

Goal-Setting Questions



Research shows that when goals are specific, difficult and based on group impact they can improve team performance.

💡 Sticking to Your Goals

Sticking to your goals requires consistent effort, focus, and the right strategies to stay on track, even when challenges arise.

Tips for Staying on Track to help you stay aligned and make steady progress:

1. Regularly Review Your Progress:

- Schedule time to assess your progress against your goals. Frequent reviews help you identify what's working and where adjustments might be needed.

2. Break Tasks Into Smaller, Actionable Steps:

- Divide larger goals into manageable tasks that are easier to tackle. This makes your progress feel more achievable and helps maintain momentum.

3. Seek Support from Your Manager or Peers:

- Don't hesitate to ask for help when you encounter obstacles. Whether it's guidance, resources, or collaboration, your manager and team are there to support you.

4. Use Available Tools to Simplify Tracking and Updates:

- Leverage tools like Bob or project management software to keep your goals organized and track progress easily. These tools help you stay focused and accountable.

By reviewing your goals regularly, breaking them into manageable steps, and seeking support when needed, you can stay on track and achieve meaningful results.



✓ Quarterly goal check-ins

Quarterly check-ins are a vital part of maintaining momentum, ensuring alignment, and adjusting goals as needed. This is a moment for you and your lead to reflect on the past months and plan your goals ahead for the upcoming quarter.

👏 Why have a quarterly check in?

👤 Track your Progress - Quarterly check-ins give you a structured opportunity to review how your goals are advancing. They help you assess whether you're on track or if changes are needed to meet deadlines.

🧱 Stay Accountable - Frequent reviews help you stay focused and committed to your goals. Regular updates ensure nothing is overlooked and keep you aligned with team priorities.

📝 Enable Adjustments - Goals can change. Check-ins allow you to adapt to new challenges or priorities, ensuring your goals stay relevant and aligned with your team, department, and company objectives.

👂 Get Feedback and Support - Quarterly check-ins create a reliable rhythm for receiving guidance and feedback. This helps identify challenges early and provides the support you need to stay on track.

👤 Stay Motivated and Engaged - Receiving feedback and recognition during check-ins boosts motivation and shows how your contributions add value to the bigger picture at DeepL.

🔧 Preparing for the session

Intentionally schedule the time in your calendar, we recommend doing it at the beginning of every quarter.

Before the meeting, prepare a summary of the last quarter (goals, projects, achievements - ensure these are updated in bob), and an idea of 3-5 goals for the next quarter (including any roll-over from the quarter that has just passed):

1. These can be written down, or you can just prepared to talk about them.

2. Think about what went well, what could have gone better, and any blockers or challenges you faced.
3. Think about your team and department's priorities, what are the projects you are responsible for? Where can you bring the most impact and apply your strengths? Are there any specific development areas you would like to focus on?

 It's not expected that you keep adding on 3-5 goals each time you have a check in. Throughout the year you should always have 3-5 ongoing goals but some can occasionally roll over to the next quarter.



During the session

- During your **Goal Check-in**, spend some time reflecting on the previous quarter. Feel free to use the template **embedded in bob**, to keep track of your goals and check-in conversations.
- Some areas to look at
 - What went well?
 - What could have gone better?
 - What blockers or challenges did you face?
 - Is there any additional support that you need from your lead?
 - Focus on personal and professional development goals too
 - Provide feedback, celebrate successes and share areas for improvement
- Agree on goals for the next quarter.
 - a. Lead and employee agree on 3-5 goals and document them in bob.
 - b. Goals can be for periods of time longer than 3 months, but then it's important to agree on milestones to be achieved in the particular quarter.
 - c. The goals should contribute to the department/ team objectives, but can also have professional development goals.
- Check in regularly on the goals during the 1:1s
 - Flag any challenges, obstacles or if you need support to get back on track.
 - We know business changes quickly, so goals can be changed or iterated if needed - let's stay agile!



After the session

- **Review Feedback and Action Items:**
 - Reflect on the feedback you received and prioritize any action items discussed during the check-in.
- **Update Your Goals:**
 - Adjust your goals or timelines based on the outcomes of the check-in to ensure they remain relevant and achievable.
- **Plan Your Next Steps:**
 - Break down any new or updated goals into smaller tasks and set timelines to maintain momentum.
- **Seek Resources or Support:**
 - If additional tools, training, or guidance were discussed, take proactive steps to access these resources.
- **Follow Up Regularly:**
 - Track your progress on the agreed action items and be prepared to share updates in future conversations.

Quarterly check-ins in bob can be a place to document wins, challenges, progress and any alignment. Your Lead will initiate this in bob and you will receive the notification to add your your check in and an event invite.

? FAQs

[Tips for Staying on Track to help you stay aligned and make steady progress:](#)

- ➡ Is this mandatory?
- ➡ Where should I track the goals and the outcomes from the goal check-ins?
- ➡ How do I know what the goals of the company and my department are?
- ➡ How many goals should an employee be setting?
- ➡ How can I align my goals with company and team objectives?
- ➡ When should goals be set?
- ➡ I am a new hire, when and how should I start setting my goals at DeepL?
- ➡ What system should I use?
- ➡ What support is available for professional development?

➡ Is this mandatory?

From 2025, we are evolving this approach by incorporating goals as a required practice for all employees, along with regular check-ins to track progress and maintain alignment with our company objectives.

➡ Where should I track the goals and the outcomes from the goal check-ins?

In bob you will be able to add goals and document your check-in within the Talent Section (Goals). In bob, there is a template set up to guide and track your conversations.

➡ How do I know what the goals of the company and my department are?

Using [Elate](#) tool, we keep track of progress against our company and departmental goals. If your department goals are not yet added, please reach out to your leads.

➡ How many goals should an employee be setting?

We recommend setting 3-5 individual goals that are aligned to the goals of the department and the company. In the spirit of growth mindset, we encourage everyone to also include one goal focused on personal development.

➡ How can I align my goals with company and team objectives?

Start with the DeepL's overarching goals, break them down into departmental goals, and then further into team goals. Individual goals should be derived from these to ensure alignment.

➡ When should goals be set?

Individual goals should be set at the start of each year and revised quarterly to align with the dynamic nature of team, department, and company objectives. Please see the [key dates](#) above for the timeline and deadline for the upcoming year. If you have joined DeepL throughout the year, make sure to check out the next FAQ.

➡ I am a new hire, when and how should I start setting my goals at DeepL?

As a new hire, you should aim to set your initial goals within your first 30 days. This ensures alignment with your team's priorities and helps you focus on key contributions early on. Work closely with your manager to identify objectives that align with your role and team priorities. Start small and actionable, focusing on learning and adapting to your responsibilities. Your first goals might focus more on onboarding, learning the tools, and understanding processes. As you settle in, your goals will naturally shift toward delivering specific outcomes aligned with team and company objectives.

➡ What system should I use?

For all employees, goal setting and tracking will be done on **bob** to ensure alignment. How to do so can be found [above](#). Everyone should have between 3-5 active goals ongoing each quarter, aligned with team priorities. We recommend making at least one of these a personal development goal. Team leads will be responsible for setting quarterly check-ins on bob with team members.

Elate will be used as the system to track Company and Department Goals and objectives. Everybody will be able to access and have a view of what's most important to the company, how we are performing, and how each department

contributes. However, only objective owners will be updating the status of company and department (or team if necessary) goals on a monthly basis.

▶ What support is available for professional development?

1. Use your [Individual Learning Budget](#) to align your goals with any professional development that is required to achieve any goals.
2. Check out the [Personal Development Plan Workbook](#)